Project: Document Management System (DMS)

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2. Project Methodology Selection for EDMS

For the Enterprise Document Management System (EDMS) project, selecting an appropriate methodology is critical to ensure proper document tracking, multi-level approval workflows, and strict security compliance. Based on our requirements analysis, we evaluated several options:

- **Waterfall Method:** A sequential approach where each SDLC phase (Planning, Analysis, Design, Implementation) must be fully finalized before starting the next. While it offers rigorous documentation, it lacks flexibility for evolving administrative user feedback.
- **Parallel Method:** Divides the EDMS into separate modules (such as user authentication, file upload, and approval routing) to be built simultaneously. This can shorten timelines, but integration overhead between modules is quite high.
- **Rapid Application Development (RAD):** Focuses on quick UI mockups and continuous feedback from administrative staff. Highly useful, though careful attention to audit logging security is required.
- **Iterative Method:** Breaks the EDMS development into sequential versions (v1 for basic upload, v2 for approval workflows, v3 for advanced audit trails). This approach reduces initial deployment risks.
- **Agile Development:** Emphasizes face-to-face communication, flexibility, and incremental delivery through short sprints.

3. Selected Approach & Justification

After reviewing our scope constraints and administrative needs, our team decided to combine aspects of the **Iterative Method** and **Agile Development** to deliver the EDMS incrementally, ensuring campus staff can test and approve document routing features progressively without operational disruption.